



**CALICUT UNIVERSITY – FOUR-YEAR UNDERGRADUATE PROGRAMME**

**(CU-FYUGP)**

**BA ENGLISH LANGUAGE & LITERATURE HONOURS**

**MAJOR**

|                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                  |                   |                    |             |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|-------------------|--------------------|-------------|
| Programme      | <b>BA ENGLISH LANGUAGE &amp; LITERATURE HONOURS</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                  |                   |                    |             |
| Course Code    | <b>ENG7CJ404</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                  |                   |                    |             |
| Course Title   | <b>ADVANCED CRITICAL THEORY</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                  |                   |                    |             |
| Type of Course | <b>MAJOR</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                  |                   |                    |             |
| Semester       | VII                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                  |                   |                    |             |
| Academic Level | 400 – 499                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                  |                   |                    |             |
| Course Details | Credit                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Lecture per week | Tutorial per week | Practical per week | Total Hours |
|                | 4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 3                | -                 | 2                  | 75          |
| Pre-requisites | Basic understanding of Critical Theory                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                  |                   |                    |             |
| Course Summary | <p>This course envisions the enhancement of students' involvement with literary theoretical frameworks and their background philosophies. It aims to transact an in-depth comprehension of the intersections between power, culture, and society through the study of critical theory. To develop the inclination for self-reflexive social critique and to familiarize with the advanced methodologies of humanist research, the course will explore a broad spectrum of late modern and post-modern theorists like Foucault, Butler, Lacan, Fanon, Spivak, and Zizek. The course should, ideally, equip the students with the conceptual vocabulary and insight to actively engage with contemporary research questions. By examining important literary ideas, critical viewpoints, and their historical progression, learners will cultivate their analytical abilities, expand their interpretive methods, and actively participate in advanced literary criticism.</p> |                  |                   |                    |             |

**Course Outcomes (CO):**

| <b>CO</b> | <b>CO Statement</b>                                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>Cognitive Level*</b> | <b>Knowledge Category#</b> | <b>Evaluation Tools used</b>                                                        |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CO1       | Proficiency in Analysing Critical Theoretical Frameworks                                                                                                                                            | U                       | C                          | Home Assignment<br>Seminar<br>Presentation &<br>In-class discussion<br>Written Test |
| CO2       | Critically examine various forms of cultural production by applying appropriate critical theories.                                                                                                  | E                       | C                          | Open book test<br>Seminar<br>In-class discussion                                    |
| CO3       | Analyse the power structures and social hierarchies embedded in different contexts                                                                                                                  | An                      | C                          | Problem-based assignment<br>Seminar<br>Presentation                                 |
| CO4       | Proficiency in intersectional analysis by investigating how various social categories (such as race, gender, and class) overlap and impact both individuals' lives and society systems.             | An                      | C                          | Home Assignment<br>Seminar<br>Presentation<br>In-class discussion<br>Written Test   |
| CO5       | Develop research skills and the ability to conduct independent inquiries, exploring advanced topics within critical theory and actively contribute to the continuous advancement of the discipline. | Ap                      | P                          | Self and Peer Assessments<br>Individual paper presentation                          |
| CO6       | To develop the capacity to apply theoretical frameworks to real-world situations and provide perceptive analyses.                                                                                   | C                       | M                          | Problem-based assignment<br>In-class discussion                                     |

\* - Remember (R), Understand (U), Apply (Ap), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C)

# - Factual Knowledge(F) Conceptual Knowledge (C) Procedural Knowledge (P) Metacognitive Knowledge (M)

**Detailed Syllabus:**

| Module    | Unit                                   | Content                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Hrs<br>(75) | Marks<br>(70) |
|-----------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------|
| <b>I</b>  | <b>Theoretical Frameworks</b>          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>10</b>   | <b>20</b>     |
|           | 1                                      | Literary theory as a Critique of Liberal Humanist Theories - Critical theory and interdisciplinary methodology                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | 3           |               |
|           | 2                                      | Structuralist Theory, Cultural Criticism - Transition to Post-structuralism and Postmodernism                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 3           |               |
|           | 3                                      | Identity Politics - the idea of Power                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 2           |               |
|           | 4                                      | Culture Industry, Institutionalization of Literary Studies, Anti-theory                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 2           |               |
|           |                                        | Detailed Study: <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Barthes, Roland. "Structuralist Activity"</li> <li>Latour, Bruno. "Why has Critique Run out of Steam?"</li> </ol> Non-Detailed Study <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Gramsci, Antonio. "The Formation of the Intellectuals"</li> <li>Ferdinand Saussure "The Nature of Linguistic Sign"</li> </ol>                                                        |             |               |
| <b>II</b> | <b>Approaches to Critical Theory-I</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>15</b>   | <b>15</b>     |
|           | 5                                      | Literary Criticism and Literary Theory–Wimsatt and Beardsley, JC Ransom, Stanley Fish, and Nussbaum.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 5           |               |
|           | 6                                      | Birmingham School and the Emergence of Cultural Studies                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 5           |               |
|           | 7                                      | Nation-State-Colonial Modernity-Post-colonial Criticism                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 5           |               |
|           |                                        | Detailed Study: <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Stanley Fish- "Is there a Text in the Class?"</li> <li>Martha Nussbaum- "The Narrative Imagination" (From Cultivating Humanity: A Classical Defence of Reform in Liberal Education)</li> </ol> Non-Detailed Study: <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Chinua Achebe "Colonialist Criticism"</li> <li>Jean Baudrillard "Simulacra and Simulations"</li> </ol> |             |               |

|            |                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |           |           |
|------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|
| <b>III</b> | <b>Approaches to Critical Theory-II</b>   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <b>10</b> | <b>20</b> |
|            | 8                                         | New Historicism and Cultural Materialism                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | 3         |           |
|            | 9                                         | Marxist Approaches, Psychoanalytic Approaches, Linguistic approach                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 4         |           |
|            |                                           | Post Structuralism and Deconstruction                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |           |           |
|            | 10                                        | Feminism and Gender studies- Queer Theory                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 3         |           |
|            |                                           | <p>Detailed Study:</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Greenblatt, Stephen “Resonance and Wonder” (From Learning to Curse)</li> <li>2. Mikhail Bakhtin “Discourse in Poetry and Discourse in the Novel” from <i>Discourse in the Novel</i></li> </ol> <p>Non-Detailed Study:</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>3. Jacques Derrida ‘Structure Sign and Play in the Discourse of the Human Sciences’</li> <li>4. Gayatri Spivak “Feminism and Critical Theory”</li> <li>5. Slavoj Zizek “Courtly Love, or Woman as a Thing.”</li> </ol> |           |           |
| <b>IV</b>  | <b>Critical Inquiry and Methodologies</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | <b>10</b> | <b>15</b> |
|            | 11                                        | Spatiality Studies - Urban Studies – Disability Studies                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 2         |           |
|            | 12                                        | Eco Criticism – Ecofeminism                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 2         |           |
|            | 13                                        | Critical theory in the Age of Technology - Digital and critical discourses                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 2         |           |
|            | 14                                        | Memory Studies - Digital archiving                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 2         |           |
|            | 15                                        | Post Humanism – Cyborg - Digital Aesthetics                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 2         |           |
|            |                                           | <p>Detailed Study:</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Cheryll Glotfelty “Literary Studies in an age of Environmental Crisis” (From the Ecocriticism Reader)</li> <li>2. Henri Lefebvre “The Production of Space”-Chapter 2 first 3 sections.</li> </ol> <p>Non-Detailed Study:</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>3. Susan Wendell "The Social Construction of Disability"</li> <li>4. Donna Haraway “A Manifesto for Cyborgs”</li> </ol>                                                                                             |           |           |

| V | PRACTICUM                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 30 |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
|   | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Analyse the broad and specific classifications and methodologies of literary theories that are rooted in various historical epochs, perspectives, and areas of emphasis.</li> <li>2. Analyse excerpts from fundamental literary theory texts</li> <li>3. Apply theoretical frameworks to specific texts such as: Read texts through a feminist lens</li> <li>4. Explore literary theories with reference to multiculturalism</li> <li>5. Critique the pervasive presence of racist/casteist/hegemonic structures in the texts</li> <li>6. Engage in a theoretical analysis of fairy tales and folk wisdom.</li> <li>7. Attempt a critical analysis of any text using any of the three major concepts discussed in the above modules.</li> <li>8. Analyse political correctness of jokes in the regional language</li> <li>9. Discuss the origin and popularity of expletives in languages.</li> <li>10. Discussion</li> <li>11. Seminar presentations</li> <li>12. Assignment</li> <li>13. Individual or group project</li> <li>14. Assigned readings</li> <li>15. Critically examining texts (literary texts)</li> <li>16. A case study analysis on a particular issue</li> </ol> |    |

Note: The course is divided into five modules, with four having total 15 fixed units and one open-ended module with a variable number of units. There are total 45 transaction hours for the fixed modules and 30 hours for the open-ended one. Internal assessments (30 marks) are split between the open-ended module (20 marks) and the fixed modules (10 marks). The final examination, however, covers only the 15 units from the fixed modules.

#### **Suggested Readings:**

1. Virginia Woolf "A Room of One's Own"
2. Georg Lukacs "Reification and the Consciousness of the Proletariat"
3. Roland Barthes "The Death of the Author"
4. Foucault, Michel. "What Is an Author?"
5. Gayatri Chakravorty Spivak "Can the Subaltern Speak?"
6. Stuart Hall "Foundations of Cultural Studies"
7. Garber, Marjorie. "Lost and Found" (sec 6 from "What isn't Literature", Chapter 3 of The Use and Abuse of Literature)
8. Williams, Raymond. "Culture and Society"
9. Wolfgang Iser "Reading Process: A Phenomenological Approach" (From Modern Criticism and Theory: A Reader)
10. Terry Eagleton "On Canon Formation" from Literary Theory: An Introduction (Essay 40 Rice and Waugh's Modern Literary Theory A Reader , Fourth Edition)

11. Terry Eagleton "Literature and History" (Chapter 1 from *Marxism and Literary Criticism*)
12. Jacques Lacan. "The Mirror Stage as Formative of the Function of the I"
13. Monique Wittig "One is not Born a Woman"
14. Franco Moretti "Graphs" (Chapter 1 from *Graphs, Maps, Trees*)
15. Heath, Stephen. "On Screen, in Frame: Film and Ideology"
16. Etienne Balibar and Pierre Macherey "Literature as an Ideological Form"
17. Laura Mulvey "Visual Pleasure and Narrative Cinema"
18. Juliet Mitchell "Femininity, Narrative and Psychoanalysis"
19. Homi Bhabha "Of Mimicry and Man: The Ambivalence of Colonial Discourse"
20. JF Lyotard "The Field: Knowledge in Computerized Societies" from *The Postmodern Condition*
21. Walter Benjamin. "The Work of Art in The Age of Mechanical Reproduction"
22. Kingsley Davis "The Urbanization of the Human Population"
23. Henri Lefebvre "The Urban Revolution"
24. JF Lyotard *The Postmodern Condition: A Report on Knowledge*
25. Jacques Derrida *Specters of Marx*
26. Jean Baudrillard "Simulacra and Simulations"
27. Oskar Negt and Alexander Kluge "Public Sphere and Experience"
28. George Orwell "Politics and the English Language"
29. Edward Said Preface to *Orientalism*
30. CP. Gilman "The Yellow Wallpaper"
31. Bruno Bettelheim "The Uses of Enchantment: The Meaning and Importance of Fairy Tales"
32. *Literary Theory: A Very Short Introduction* by Jonathan Culler
33. *Cultural Studies: Theory and Practice* by Chris Barker
34. *Key Concepts in Cultural Theory* by Andrew Edgar and Peter Sedgwick
35. Ashcroft, Bill, Gareth Griffiths and Helen Tiffin (Ed.). *The Post-Colonial Studies Reader*. Routledge.
36. ---, ed. *The Empire Writes Back : Theory and Practice in Post-Colonial Literatures*, 1989
37. Barry, Peter. *Beginning Theory: An Introduction to Literary and Cultural Theory*. New Delhi: Viva Books, 2008.
38. Butler, Judith. *Gender Trouble*, Routledge, 1990.
39. Culler, Jonathan. *Literary Theory: A Very Short Introduction*. Oxford U. P, 2000.
40. Donald E. Hall et al, Eds. *The Routledge Queer Studies Reader*. 2013.
41. Eagleton, Terry. *Criticism and Ideology: A Study in Marxist Literary Theory*. 1985.
42. Gilbert, Sandra and Susan Gubar. *The Madwoman in the Attic: The Woman Writer and the Nineteenth Century Literary Imagination*. 1979.
43. Glotfelty, Cheryll and Harold Fromm (Ed.) *The Ecocriticism Reader: Landmarks in Literary Ecology*. The University of Georgia Press, 1996.
44. Hiltner, Ken. Ed. *Ecocriticism: The Essential Reader*, 2015.
45. Jameson, Fredric. *Poststructuralism; or The Cultural Logic of Late Capitalism*. 1991.
46. Lodge, David and Nigel Wood (Ed.) *Modern Criticism and Theory: A Reader* (Second edition). Pearson, 1988.
47. Mirzoeff, Nicholas. Ed. *Visual Culture Reader*. 2002.
48. Mitchell, Juliet. *Psychoanalysis and Feminism: A Radical Assessment of Freudian Psychoanalysis*. Basic Books, 2000.

**Academic Journals:**

1. Journal of Literary Theory (<http://www.jltonline.de/>)
2. Textual Practice (<https://www.tandfonline.com/>)
3. Critical Inquiry (<https://criticalinquiry.uchicago.edu/>)
4. Poetics Today (<https://read.dukeupress.edu/poetics-today>)

**Online:**

1. Max Horkheimer. <https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/horkheimer/>
2. Georg Lukacs. <https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/lukacs/>
3. Herbert Marcuse. <https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/marcuse/>
4. Michel Foucault. <https://plato.stanford.edu/entries/foucault/>

**Mapping of COs with PSOs and POs:**

|      | PSO 1 | PSO 2 | PSO 3 | PSO 4 | PSO 5 | PSO 6 | PO 1 | PO 2 | PO 3 | PO 4 | PO 5 | PO 6 | PO 7 |
|------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|-------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
| CO 1 | 3     | 1     | 2     | 3     | 2     | 1     | 3    | 2    | 3    | 2    | 2    | 2    | 3    |
| CO 2 | -     | 2     | 3     | 3     | 2     | 3     | 3    | 2    | 3    | 3    | 2    | 2    | 2    |
| CO 3 | 3     | 2     | 3     | 2     | 2     | 1     | 1    | 1    | 2    | 2    | 3    | 2    | 3    |
| CO 4 | -     | 1     | 3     | 2     | 1     | 2     | 1    | 1    | 3    | 2    | 3    | 2    | 1    |
| CO 5 | 3     | 1     | 2     | 3     | 2     | 1     | 2    | 2    | 2    | 1    | 3    | 2    | 3    |

**Correlation Levels:**

| Level | Correlation        |
|-------|--------------------|
| -     | Nil                |
| 1     | Slightly / Low     |
| 2     | Moderate / Medium  |
| 3     | Substantial / High |

**Assessment Rubrics:**

- Quiz/ Discussion/ Seminar (10%)
- Internal Exam (10%)
- Assignment (10%)
- End Semester Exam (70%)

**Mapping of Cos to Assessment Rubrics:**

|            | <b>Quiz/ Discussion/<br/>Seminar (10%)</b> | <b>Internal Exam<br/>(10%)</b> | <b>Assignment<br/>(10%)</b> | <b>End Semester<br/>Exam (70%)</b> |
|------------|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>CO1</b> | ✓                                          | ✓                              | ✓                           | ✓                                  |
| <b>CO2</b> | ✓                                          | ✓                              | ✓                           | ✓                                  |
| <b>CO3</b> | ✓                                          | ✓                              | ✓                           | ✓                                  |
| <b>CO4</b> | ✓                                          | ✓                              | ✓                           | ✓                                  |
| <b>CO5</b> | ✓                                          | ✓                              | ✓                           | ✓                                  |
| <b>CO6</b> | ✓                                          | ✓                              | ✓                           | ✓                                  |